

START + TRUTHS

- Three amber pulses burn through the storm from a beacon that has been dark for thirteen years. Far offshore, a grain ship answers and turns toward the reef. Tidewarden Mara Vale presses a brass signal key into the party's hand: 'You have one tide to make that light tell the truth.'
- The beacon's Brineworn Orb stores the final memory of Keeper Orren Saye.
- Corsair scout Nera Voss altered the shutters to lure one specific guild ship onto the reef.
- The false signal agitates the glassfin creatures nesting in the tide pools.
- The beacon can be repaired, retuned, extinguished, or surrendered to Orren; no single ending is mandatory.

SCENES 1-2

- 1. The Answering Ship: The party reaches the tower or secures Nera as an ally, captive, or active rival.
- Pressure: Nera cuts one bridge support if cornered, but prefers a deal to a fight.
- 2. The Keeper's Room: The party learns at least two truths and chooses whether to approach Orren as threat, witness, or potential ally.
- Pressure: At False Signal step 2, the glassfin brood climbs into the room through the broken shutters.

SCENES 3-4

- 3. The Brass Stair: The party enters the lantern room with the mechanism intact, damaged, or stopped.
- Pressure: Every failed or abandoned method advances one clock chosen by the GM.
- 4. A Light That Remembers: The ship's fate, Orren's fate, Nera's cause, and the beacon's future are each stated aloud.
- Pressure: When either clock fills, saving every objective becomes impossible; the party must name what they protect.

CLOCKS + END

- FLOOD TIDE: [] [] [] [] [] []
- FALSE SIGNAL: [] [] [] []
- State aloud: ship, Orren, Nera, beacon.
- True Light: the ship clears the reef and Gullwatch returns to service under new witnesses.
- Carried Memory: Orren leaves inside the signal key and the dark tower becomes a contested salvage site.
- Public Reckoning: the guild theft is broadcast, saving the ship while igniting a harbor strike.
- Broken Beacon: the party saves survivors directly, but navigation along the coast becomes dangerous for weeks.